Phyo Thihan Nyein

Strategy & Business Development | SME / MSME Growth | Myanmar & Southeast Asia Markets
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PROFILE

Strategy and business-development leader with 5+ years driving market expansion, partnership-led growth, and small-business (SME/MSME) development across Myanmar and US markets. Built multi-year growth strategies, led go-to-market for new retail and commercial formats, and forged supplier and ecosystem partnerships that opened new revenue and value propositions. Deep on-the-ground knowledge of the Myanmar commercial landscape and the small-business segment. Seeking to bring that market access and commercial-growth expertise to Mastercard's SME business across Thailand and Myanmar.

CORE STRENGTHS

SME & MSME ecosystem development · Go-to-market & market expansion · Partnership & stakeholder management · Multi-year growth strategy · New-format & channel launch · Loyalty & rewards programs · P&L-oriented planning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Capital Diamond Star Group (CDSG) – Retail Cluster Nov 2022 – Present
Senior Manager, Strategy & Business Development · Yangon, Myanmar

- Formulated the 3–5-year growth strategy for CDSG's retail cluster (convenience stores, supermarkets, hypermarkets), targeting a 2x market-share increase through new touchpoints, new formats, and new revenue initiatives
- Led go-to-market for new retail formats (wholesale and lifestyle retail) and the acquisition of supermarket and convenience-store chains, expanding CDSG's retail footprint in Myanmar ***(140% footprint growth)***
- Built MSME and local-supplier development programs and community events that onboarded local small businesses into CDSG's retail channels, positioning CDSG as a top route-to-market for local products
- Originated and managed strategic partnerships with key Myanmar suppliers to launch new products, services, and customer value propositions ***(Partnership with Carlsberg & Royal-D)***
- Built the private-label strategy and product pipeline with the merchandising team, targeting a 1–3% gross-profit uplift ***(GP impact of 4% with sales contribution of over 1.5%)***
- Co-developed the customer loyalty & rewards program and a corporate venture-capital initiative, laying data-driven foundations for customer engagement and new growth bets

KMA Group of Companies Jul 2020 – Oct 2022
Assistant Manager, Strategy & Business Development

- Stood up a new Myanmar e-commerce venture end-to-end — organizational blueprint, departmental structure, and key hires — under the Executive Director.
- Built growth and marketing strategy, SOPs, KPIs, and hiring frameworks for KMA's US hospitality and arts/craft portfolio (United KMA Inc.).
- Represented KMA at the SelectUSA 2021 Investment Summit, developing US market-entry and investment options for senior management.
- Introduced productivity tools and new business processes that improved transparency and efficiency across the business-development group, working directly with the Managing and Executive Directors on change management.

Silicon Valley Center of Technology & Operations Management (SJSU) Jun 2018 – Dec 2019
Assistant Project Manager

- Coordinated 200+ entrepreneurs and international students and set KPIs for training and entrepreneurial programs, reporting process improvements directly to the Director.
- Built international university partnership programs (SJSU–KAIST, SJSU–FAU) with institutions in South Korea and Germany.

- Supported tech-startup incubation at SJSU, providing operational and go-to-market support to early-stage ventures.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Tagtik — Digital Ordering Platform (Restaurant Sector) Jun 2018 – Dec 2019
Co-founder

- Co-founded a digital ordering and payments-adjacent platform for the restaurant industry; secured approximately $60,000 in equity-free grant funding through incubator, VC, and PE pitches.
- Built and beta-tested the prototype across the United States and South Korea, adapting UI/UX and operational processes to regional preferences.

EDUCATION

San Jose State University — San Jose, CA, USA Dec 2019
B.S., Business Administration — Global Operations Management; Minor in Applied Computing for Social & Behavioral Sciences
Recipient, 2019 Global Operations Management Scholarship

ADDITIONAL

Leadership: Vice President, Global Operations Management Association · Analyst, Silicon Valley Aggressive Growth Fund · Independent Consulting (pro bono), Dec 2019 – Present
Languages: English & Burmese (fluent, written and verbal) · Mandarin Chinese (conversational)
Technical: Microsoft Office Suite · CRM & sales-enablement tools · Python & R (basics) · Slack · AI prompting